

Paulius Alaburda

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Summary

Head of Data Analytics in energy. I specialise in data reporting, warehousing, governance and end-to-end data solutions. I love ensuring that data teams work on the right things and seize opportunities, all while setting a high bar for quality.

Experience

Head of Data Analytics - Ignitis

December 2021 – present · Vilnius, Lithuania

Own the data function for Lithuania and Latvia by leading a cross-functional team of data professionals.

- Grew the team from 3 data analysts to 18 people, spanning Data Engineers, Data Analysts, Data Stewards and Data Scientists.
- Built an internal data platform using Airflow, SQL Server, dbt, and Microsoft Fabric, housing over 80 distinct data sources.
- Led Power BI adoption by creating actionable reports, reaching all business units, with 520 active users.
- Established a Data Governance programme to increase data quality and define data ownership.
- Created multiple data products on the data platform and on Kubernetes, including:
 - A smart meter API service serving customer-facing systems at subsecond latency;
 - A physical address service used by other internal systems as a source of truth;
 - An internal AI agent helping customer support employees;
 - A reverse ETL service to capture EV station incidents, resulting in an 80% reduction in client complaints.
- Drove GitHub Copilot adoption in the organisation by running workshops and holding a monthly AI Ambassador meetup.

Senior Data Analyst - Ignitis

April 2021 – November 2021 · Vilnius, Lithuania

Served reporting needs as well as advanced analytical use cases, and managed the backlog and work of three analysts.

- Developed ETL pipelines to centralise data and ensure faster turnaround time for new data requests.
- Segmented the client base by combining multiple data sources and applying PCA, resulting in 4 distinct customer profiles that informed client-facing communication.
- Co-authored a Data Governance standard, paving the way for the role of Data Stewards in the organisation.
- Interviewed potential data analysts to backfill the team.

Data Analyst - Ignitis

July 2019 – March 2021 · Vilnius, Lithuania

Met reporting and data extraction needs of commercial, finance and wholesale business units using a suite of analytical tools: Power BI, SQL, R, Python and Power Automate.

- Conducted data operations related to energy deregulation, ensuring accurate and timely regulatory submissions and marketing campaigns.
- Introduced version control for the team's codebase to replace shared-drive files and ensure work does not get lost.
- Built an internal R library to facilitate data extraction tasks and reduce turnaround time.

Data Analyst - Aon

November 2018 – May 2019 · Chicago, United States · Internship sponsored by the Baltic-American Freedom Foundation, Global Claims team

Supported the Global Claims team with data preparation, quality control and reporting across global claims data using R and Tableau.

Writing & Speaking

- **High SQL** — personal technical substack.
- **alaburda.github.io** — personal technical blog.
- **I Love DuckDB** — talk at the Business Garden R User Group Meeting, 2024.
- **Data Analyst SQL Cookbook** — a collected set of practical SQL techniques for day-to-day analytical work.

Education

- **Doctor of Medicine (MD)** — Lithuanian University of Health Sciences, 2012 – 2018. Integrated master's programme.

Earlier career

Before data, I spent five years doing research on cell morphology at the Institute of Anatomy, LSMU (2013 – 2018) and co-authored four peer-reviewed papers. Alongside it, I coached high-school students for the Biology Olympiad (2016 – 2019) — a student I tutored won a silver medal internationally in 2018.